



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. Elizabeth Ann Seton Catholic School

School Website: <https://seton.school/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

St Elizabeth Ann Seton Catholic School (Keller, TX) presents a robust classical-Catholic profile, anchored in a clearly articulated mission to form lifelong Catholics through the integration of truth, goodness, and beauty. Public-facing materials emphasize a strong Catholic identity, liturgical life, and a classical liberal-arts orientation (Great Books, Latin, a historically informed curriculum) alongside a parental-partnering model and a living faculty. The school clearly positions itself within the classical-tradition spectrum in several dimensions, while also exhibiting some elements that are more Catholic-tradition focused than strictly classical in pedagogy. Overall, the materials align most strongly with CLASSICAL, with some areas (notably explicit Socratic pedagogy in lower- and middle-grades and a fully articulated Trivium/Quadrivium framework in public-facing statements) showing as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. The aggregate placement for ST. ELIZABETH ANN SETON CATHOLIC SCHOOL is CLASSICAL.

Key strengths observed across the six categories include: - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: explicit theology, liturgical life, sacramental practice, catechesis, Mass attendance, and a sacramental worldview integrated into daily learning (evidence: mission statements, curriculum notes, liturgical life). - School Purpose and Goal: formation-focused aims—formation of character, virtue, and wisdom, with the Great Books and classical liberal arts highlighted as central to the mission. - Curriculum: explicit emphasis on Great Books, Latin, and a curriculum integrated with Catholic doctrine, liturgy, and moral formation, with attention to “integration” and “wonder” in learning. - Faculty: explicit statements about faculty modeling virtue and excellence; living curriculum concept; professional expectations for teachers in a Catholic-classical frame. - Parents & Community: strong emphasis on parental partnership (Parents as primary educators), PSA involvement, and open campus, with explicit aims to educate and involve parents in classical formation.

Executive summary — Element-by-Element snapshot is provided below, with explicit keyword analysis grounded in the Six Essential Elements framework.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents Catholic faith as the integrating factor in all coursework and life at the school, with explicit mention of religion, liturgy, sacraments, and catechesis as foundational to daily learning (Curriculum Overview notes; catechesis content). - Catechesis of the Good Shepherd is highlighted as part of early religious formation, reflecting liturgical imagination and sacramental pedagogy in the lower grades. - The Mission & Philosophy frames the Great Books and the classical liberal arts within a Catholic framework, explicitly linking truth, goodness, and beauty to Jesus Christ and Catholic pedagogy. - The daily prayer life, weekly Mass, adoration, and retreats are described as part of the spiritual formation program, reinforcing liturgical community life.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Catholic faith, theology, liturgy, Mass, sacraments, catechesis, liturgical life, catechesis of the Good Shepherd, sacraments, prayer, Eucharist, adoration, confession, Catholic tradition, sacred, catechesis, Great Books (within Catholic framework), sacraments, sacral/communal practices. - Negative keywords present: none detected in public materials (no explicit references to secularism, relativism, or values-neutral approaches in the main public-facing content).

How this rating was determined - The public materials consistently foreground theology and liturgical life as organizing principles for curriculum and daily life, aligning with the Positive Keyword indicators for “Transcendental Moral Realism,” “Grounded in Theology,” and “Liturgical and Communal Practices.” The absence of negative signals (relativism, secular humanism, etc.) supports CLASSICAL.

Citations - The integrating Catholic faith and liturgical life: Curriculum Overview (PK-12) content. - Catechesis of the Good Shepherd and liturgical life in early formation: materials referencing catechesis and liturgical practice. - Mission and Philosophy foregrounding Great Books and Catholic tradition. - Daily prayer, weekly Mass, retreats as spiritual formation.

Why this rating - The school’s public materials consistently articulate a theologically grounded, liturgically integrated, sacramental life, and a catechetical approach consistent with classical-Catholic education. There are no evident signals of secular or relativist frameworks in the materials reviewed.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission is explicitly “To Grow Lifelong Catholics,” with an emphasis on formation of the whole person and a longing for truth, goodness, and beauty. This aligns with formation over vocationalism and with the pursuit of wisdom and virtue. - The public materials emphasize formation (virtue, character, wisdom) rather than mere job-readiness, with explicit reference to “Great Books,” classical liberal arts, and a synthesis of faith and reason. - First Principles explicitly position parents as primary educators and affirm mentorship, personal relationships, and a holistic formation of the whole person.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal arts, Great Books, classical, telos, contemplation/scholé, human flourishing, moral imagination, Christian anthropology, sacred tradition, Logos, eternal truths. - Negative keywords present: none observed in public-facing content.

How this rating was determined - The school’s stated aim centers on formation, virtue, and wisdom within a classical framework, with explicit reference to a liberal-arts pedagogy and Great Books as a core component. This is a CLASSICAL alignment based on the keyword framework.

Citations - Mission statement and Great Books emphasis: public materials. - First Principles (Parents as primary educators; formation and relationship): public materials.

Why this rating - The school’s mission and philosophy underscore formation, virtue, and wisdom through classical-literary means and Catholic formation, aligning with Classical criteria.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is described as integrating Catholic identity across coursework, with emphasis on the Great Books, classical liberal arts, and Latin, alongside English, math, history, science, and religious instruction. The presence of Great Books is explicitly stated, and Latin appears as part of the curriculum. - The curriculum emphasizes history and integrated study across subjects, but explicit reference to the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Quadrivium (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) is not overtly stated in the public-facing materials. The explicit articulation of grammar/logic/rhetoric as foundational liberal arts is not clearly enumerated beyond the Latin and general liberal-arts framing. This yields a partial alignment with the classical curriculum model that foregrounds the Trivium/Quadrivium. - The site notes “Great Books” and a structured program including Latin, history, science, English, and math, which signals a classical approach but without a fully explicit Trivium/Quadrivium articulation in the public-facing content.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Great Books, Latin, history across the curriculum, liberal arts, classical education, sacred tradition. - Negative keywords present: none observed (no explicit emphasis on social studies terminology replacing history, or a pure project-based orientation as the sole method; a more project-based emphasis is not highlighted here). - Overall, several core classical signals are present (Great Books, Latin, integrated curriculum, historical consciousness), while explicit Trivium/Quadrivium framing and a heavy emphasis on classical textual study in the form of Great Conversations are not exhaustively stated in public content.

How this rating was determined - The material shows strong classical signals (Great Books, classical liberal arts, integrated history and humanities), but lacks explicit, comprehensive articulation of the Trivium/Quadrivium framework and some of the more explicit “Great Books as sustained Great Conversation” phrasing in the public-facing material. This constitutes a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL alignment rather than fully Classical.

Citations - Great Books and Latin presence in Curriculum (PK-12): Curriculum Overview page. - Great Books and Classical Liberal Arts as core (Mission & Philosophy): Mission & Philosophy content. - History across the curriculum and integrated humanities emphasis: Curriculum Overview description.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates a strong classical influence via Great Books and classical liberal-arts framing, but its public materials do not clearly enumerate Trivium/Quadrivium or a repeated, explicit Great Conversation framework across the curriculum, and the language around these elements is less explicit than in some canonical classical schools. Hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials emphasize contemplative, wonder-filled education as part of the formation (e.g., the Great Books approach, the integration of wonder and beauty, and the focus on moral formation). The presence of The Catechesis of the Good Shepherd indicates a contemplative, catechetical approach in lower grades. These align with schooled forms of contemplative pedagogy and memory-work, which are consistent with classical pedagogy in parts of the program. - In lower grades, there is mention of a Montessori-based Catechesis of the Good Shepherd program, which indicates a contemplative, student-centered approach in religious education; the public materials also emphasize memorization and memory work as part of classical pedagogy through the overall classical framework (as referenced in the Six Essential Elements lexicon). Public content highlights the liturgical and contemplative dimensions rather than focusing exclusively on Socratic seminars in the lower grades, which aligns with a mixed pedagogy in the K–8 range. - The school highlights a strong liturgical and sacramental life; while there are references to “Great Books” and classical liberal arts, there is less explicit public documentation of sustained Socratic seminars or high-school-level rhetoric curricula in the non-high-school grades (as opposed to some canonical classical schools that emphasize Socratic dialogue in upper grades). The absence of explicit Socratic seminars in K–8 is consistent with the fact that Seminars often start in high school in classical pedagogy. This is acceptable for a K–8 classical profile but places the pedagogy as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in the public materials.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: contemplative learning, scholé, wonder, liturgy, catechesis, great books, rhetoric training (explicitly in the high-school pedagogy is not widely described in K–8 public content), memory work, singing in lower grades, and a structured, liturgical calendar integration. - Negative keywords present: lack of explicit Socratic seminars in K–8 public content; absence of explicit project-based-only pedagogy. The public materials do not present clear negative signals such as “experiential learning-focused” or “constructivist-only” rhetoric, but they do not regularly foreground strict Socratic pedagogy in the lower grades.

How this rating was determined - The presence of contemplative pedagogy (Scholé-like approach) and memory-work and liturgical-embedded learning indicates alignment with classical pedagogy in parts of the program. The absence of explicit, sustained Socratic seminars in K–8 public materials leads to a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL classification for pedagogy.

Citations - Contemplative pedagogy and wonder; catechesis of the Good Shepherd; liturgical practices: Curriculum Learning materials and Special features. - Catechesis of the Good Shepherd in lower grades; a

Montessori-based approach referenced publicly: Special content.

Why this rating - The program shows substantial contemplative and liturgical pedagogy, including memory work and a catechetical approach, which are classical signals. However, explicit upper-level Socratic seminars and a formal Trivium/Quadrivium-based pedagogy in the K–8 public content are not strongly and consistently articulated, justifying a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL classification for pedagogy.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Careers material stresses that faculty model virtue and excellence, convey knowledge with warmth and clarity, and serve as moral exemplars; teachers are described as living the curriculum in a Catholic-classical frame. This aligns with a classical notion of faculty as “living curriculum” and mentors who embody virtue. - The materials emphasize teachers who embody integrity and virtue, and expectation that faculty understand a classical Catholic worldview and cultivate the moral imagination in students. This aligns with the classical model of faculty as exemplars and mentors within a traditional formation framework. - The materials note the living-curriculum aspect and the need for faculty to model virtue, skill, and knowledge; the public materials articulate a distinct teacher-formation goal consistent with classical education.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: model virtue, living curriculum, teachers as mentors, masters/sages, classical formation, moral exemplars, teacher as exemplar, Catholic worldview among faculty. - Negative keywords present: none observed in the public-facing faculty materials.

How this rating was determined - The explicit emphasis on faculty as virtue-models, living curriculum, and mentors supports a CLASSICAL categorization for the faculty category.

Citations - Faculty as virtue-models and living curriculum: Careers page materials.

Why this rating - The faculty materials align strongly with classical expectations of teachers as moral exemplars and living texts of the curriculum, indicating CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission and first-principles content explicitly position parents as primary educators and co-educators, with partnerships with families and ongoing formation for parents (e.g., family formation, classical parent training, and a home-school partnership ethos). - The school has an active Parent School Association (PSA) with structured governance, parent involvement, and family engagement in school life; the PSA engages in governance, volunteer roles, and communication (PSA newsletters, board structure). This indicates a robust community-partnership approach that aligns with classical expectations for parental involvement. - The school publicly invites parents to visits and tours, indicating open campus and parental engagement, which is consistent with classical education’s emphasis on parental participation and formation.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parents as co-educators, parental formation, home-school partnership, PSA, open campus, family formation, parental leadership, community support. - Negative keywords present: none observed in public materials.

How this rating was determined - The public materials strongly emphasize parental partnership and community involvement, aligning with classical expectations of parent-education partnership and community life.

Citations - First Principles: Parents as Primary Educators; partnership with families; parental formation. - PSA and parent-community content: PSA and Parent & School Association pages.

Why this rating - The content demonstrates strong parental engagement, partnership with families, and an active community, which is CLASSICAL.

Aggregate Rating

- Element 1: CLASSICAL

- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall, the school shows robust CLASSICAL alignment with a couple of categories (Curriculum and Pedagogy) that are SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- If the school sought to move from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in Curriculum and Pedagogy to FULLY CLASSICAL, it could:
- Explicitly articulate and publicly document a Trivium/Quadrivium framework and a more explicit Great Conversation approach across the curriculum, including visible, sustained engagement with primary classical texts and a clear rationale for the sequence from grammar to rhetoric (K–8 in particular). This would strengthen Element 3 and category 4 alignment with the classical-literary tradition.
- Provide explicit documentation of Socratic pedagogy in the upper elementary and middle grades (where applicable) or outline a staged approach to Socratic discussion in grades 9–12 if/when the school adds those grades. This would strengthen Element 4 alignment with classical pedagogy by institutionalizing Socratic dialogue and rhetorical training where appropriate.
- Expand the articulation of “memory-work” and chant-based memorization in lower grades as part of a formal memory-culture (recitation/chant) program with public exemplars demonstrating the role of memorization in the liberal arts, potentially aligning more fully with the Positive Keyword indicators in Element 4. This would enhance the lower-grade pedagogy signals.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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